

- 8 (a) Over the past 200 years, many species of animals and plants have become extinct.

Fig. 8.1 shows the changes between the years 1800 and 2000 in:

- the number of species becoming extinct
- the size of the world human population.

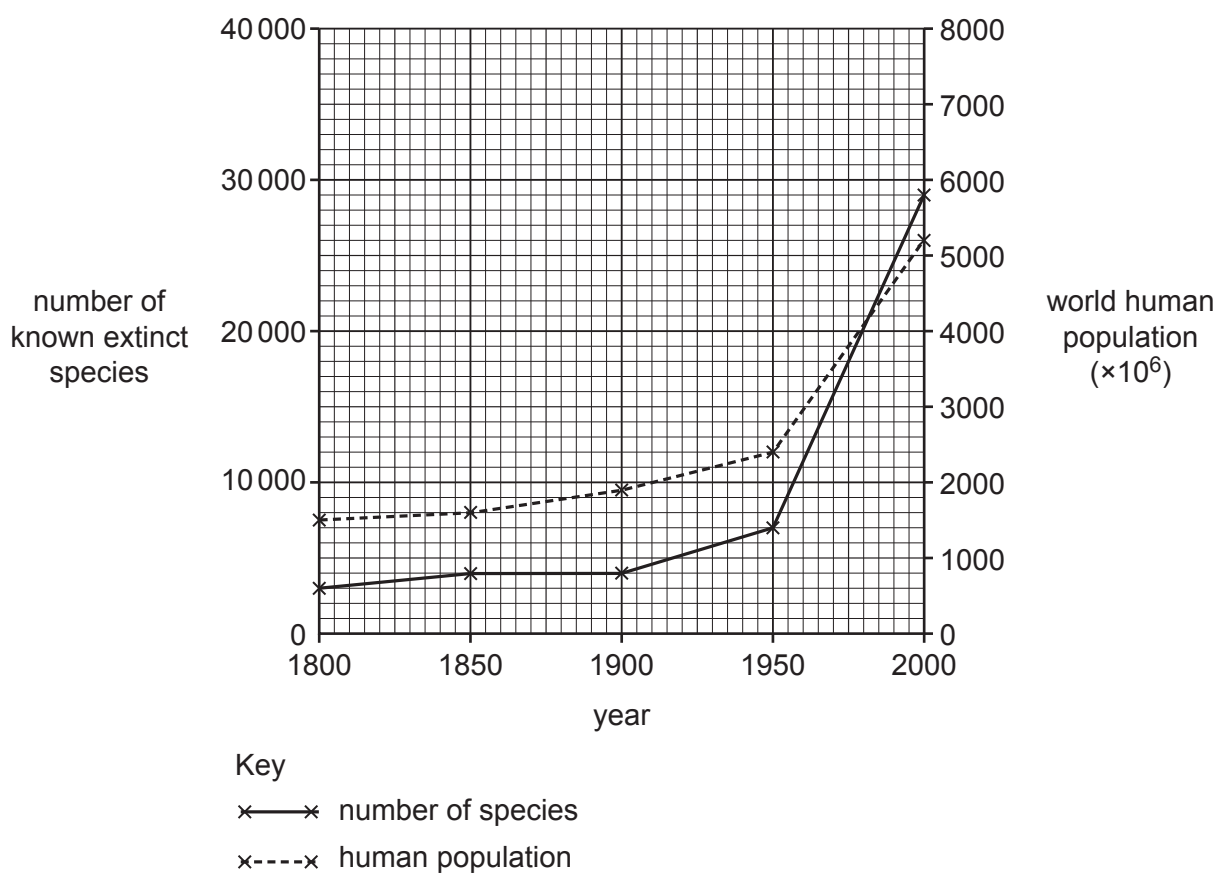


Fig. 8.1

- (i) It has been suggested that there is a correlation between the number of species becoming extinct and the size of the world human population.

Suggest reasons for this possible correlation.

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- (ii) Calculate the rate of species extinction per year between 1950 and 2000.

Show your working.

answer = [2]

- (b)** Extinction of animal and plant species reduces biodiversity.

Explain why it is important to maintain biodiversity.

[7]

[Total:12]